

Ecclesiastical Latin

EL-II.3: Infinitives and Indirect Statement

Form the six ordinary infinitives and preserve subject, voice, and relative time in complementary and indirect-statement structures

Stage	Stage II — Core Grammar
Prerequisite	EL-II.2 mastery: control comparison, adverbs, and operational numerals
Next	EL-II.4, Participles and the Ablative Absolute

Read *EL-GUIDE: Start Here* before using this packet. Course method, pacing, source conventions, and answer protocol are stated there; this module begins with its lesson and assumes previously taught terms.

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Part I

Lesson

CHAPTER 1

Infinitives and indirect statement

On completing this unit, you can:

- form all six ordinary infinitives and state their relative time and voice;
- distinguish complementary, subject, object, and indirect-statement infinitives;
- identify the accusative subject and predicate complement of indirect statement;
- preserve relative time when converting direct speech to reported speech.

1.1 The infinitive system

An **infinitive** is a non-finite verbal form: it expresses tense and voice but not grammatical person. Its **relative time** locates its action before, at the same time as, or after the action of its governing verb; the label “present infinitive” therefore means simultaneous, not necessarily present on the calendar. An **indirect statement** reports a thought, perception, or assertion in its ordinary form as an accusative subject plus infinitive rather than quoting it as an independent finite clause.

Forms and relative time

	Present (simultaneous)	Perfect (prior)	Future (subsequent)
Active	<i>amare</i>	<i>amavisse</i>	<i>amaturus, -a, -um esse</i>
Passive	<i>amari</i>	<i>amatus, -a, -um esse</i>	<i>amatum iri</i>

Present passive infinitives are *amari, moneri, regi, capi, audiri*: the first, second, and fourth conjugations replace the active infinitive’s final *-e* with *-i*, while the third and third-*-io* use the present stem without its short vowel plus *-i*. Perfect passive and future active participles agree with their accusative subject in indirect statement: *dicit hostiam oblatam esse; dicit Christum venturum esse*. The future passive *amatum iri* is invariant and rare; ecclesiastical prose often substitutes *fore ut* + subjunctive.

The infinitive tense is relative to the governing verb, not calendar time. Thus *dixit eum venire* means he said the man was coming then; *dixit eum venisse*, that he had come; *dixit eum venturum esse*, that he would come.

Four jobs

1. A **complementary infinitive** completes the meaning of verbs such as *possum, debeo, volo, nolo, incipio*: *possumus orare*.
2. A **subject infinitive** fills the subject slot and acts as a neuter singular noun: *orare bonum est*.
3. Some verbs order or permit an accusative to act: *iube hæc perferri*; the accusative is logical subject of the passive infinitive.
4. Verbs of saying, thinking, knowing, perceiving, and their passives introduce indirect statement: accusative subject + infinitive. A reflexive *se* refers to the reporting subject. Predicate nouns/adjectives are accusative: *scimus Christum Dominum esse*.

1.2 Reading the forms in context

Worked example: simultaneous action in reported thought (Luke 2:44)

Worked passage ID: W.II.9; exact source and collation state are recorded in the passage inventory.

Existimantes autem illum esse in comitatu, venerunt iter diei.

Analysis. *Existimantes* introduces indirect statement. Accusative *illum* is subject of present infinitive *esse*; his supposed presence is simultaneous with their thinking. *Iter diei* is an accusative of extent with a genitive measure.

Translation. “Thinking that he was in the company, they traveled a day’s journey.”

Worked example: an ordered passive action in the Canon

Worked passage ID: W.II.10; exact source and collation state are recorded in the passage inventory.

Iube hæc perferri per manus sancti Angeli tui in sublime altare tuum.

Analysis. Imperative *iube* takes accusative *hæc* as the subject of present passive infinitive *perferri*. The present infinitive marks action simultaneous with the command, not present clock time.

Translation. “Command these things to be carried by the hands of your holy Angel to your altar on high.”

Worked example: two dependent infinitives before Communion

Worked passage ID: W.II.11; exact source and collation state are recorded in the passage inventory.

Fac me tuis semper inhærere mandatis, et a te numquam separari permittas.

Analysis. *Me* is the understood subject of active *inhærere* after *fac*; it is also the understood subject of passive *separari* after *permittas*. *mandatis* is dative with *inhærere*; *a te* marks separation.

Translation. “Make me always cling to your commandments, and never permit me to be separated from you.”

Worked example: predicate accusative (Romans 6:11)

Worked passage ID: W.II.12; exact source and collation state are recorded in the passage inventory.

Ita et vos existimate, vos mortuos quidem esse peccato, viventes autem Deo, in Christo Iesu Domino nostro.

Analysis. *Existimate* introduces reported judgment. *vos* is the accusative subject of *esse*; predicate *mortuos* agrees with it. Parallel *viventes* shares the omitted *esse*. Datives *peccato* and *Deo* express relation.

Translation. “So you too, consider yourselves indeed dead to sin but alive to God in Christ Jesus our Lord.”

1.3 Writing laboratory

Copy the six-infinitive grid for *amo*, then reproduce it for *rego* and the deponent *sequor* (present *sequi*, perfect *secutum esse*, future *secuturum esse*). Draw a time line under each tense.

Turn *Christus venit* (present, “comes”) / *venit* (perfect, “came/has come”) / *veniet* (future) into statements after *Sacerdos dicit* and after *Sacerdos dixit*. Compose “We believe Christ to be Lord,” “He said that the offering had been received,” and “Command the gifts to be blessed.” Explicitly mark each accusative subject.

Part II

Practice

CHAPTER 1

Transfer, retrieval, and application

1.1 The infinitive system — transfer practice

Connection. A two-dimensional voice/time axis prevents form labels from being reduced to one English infinitive.

Transfer task. Place all six lesson infinitives for one regular verb on an active/passive by simultaneous/prior/subsequent grid. Under each, write its morphological components rather than a full translation.

Retrieval check. State the relative time represented by present, perfect, and future infinitives.

1.2 Reading the forms in context — transfer practice

Connection. Complementary and indirect-statement minimal pairs can contain the same infinitive while assigning different subject structure.

Transfer task. Take one infinitive from the lesson and diagram its complementary use beside an indirect statement. Box the governing verb, circle any accusative subject, and draw the understood-subject link where no new subject is expressed.

Retrieval check. Give the decisive structural difference between the two constructions.

1.3 Writing laboratory — transfer practice

Connection. A time axis checks whether conversion to reported speech preserves chronology when the reporting verb changes.

Transfer task. Use the lesson's three direct-time prompts. For each, mark event time relative to reporting time, then convert after a present reporting verb and after a past reporting verb without changing that relation.

Retrieval check. Explain why a perfect infinitive need not refer to an event remote from the speaker's present.

Part III

Worksheets

CHAPTER 1

Infinitives and indirect statement: parallel forms

Worksheet II.9 — Infinitives A

Worksheet ID: II.9

Focus: six infinitives, accusative subject, relative time**Use:** Draw a time arrow from each infinitive to its governing verb.

1. Give all six infinitives of *amo*.

2. Change direct *Christus venit* (he has come) after *Sacerdos dicit*.

3. Translate the time contrast: *dixit eum orare / oravisse / oraturum esse*.

4. Explain agreement in *dicit hostias oblatas esse*.

5. **Text:** *Existimantes autem illum esse in comitatu, venerunt iter diei*.

Passage ID: II.9.1; exact source and collation state are recorded in the passage inventory.

Mark the reported thought and translate.

6. Write in Latin: “We know that Christ is Lord and that he will come.”

Worksheet II.12 — Infinitives D**Worksheet ID:** II.12**Focus:** six infinitives, accusative subject, relative time**Use:** Draw a time arrow from each infinitive to its governing verb.

1. Give the infinitive system of deponent *sequor*.

2. Report *Nos peccavimus* with a reflexive after *Confitentur*.

3. Translate *putabant Christum venturum esse*.

4. Explain why *dicit se Dominum esse* can be ambiguous outside context.

5. **Text:** *Ita et vos existimate, vos mortuos quidem esse peccato, viventes autem Deo, in Christo Iesu Domino nostro.*

Passage ID: II.12.1; exact source and collation state are recorded in the passage inventory.

Supply the ellipsis and translate.

6. Write in Latin: “He ordered the offering to be carried and said that it had been received.”

Part IV

Assessment

CHAPTER 1

Mastery assessment and record

Advance when: Form at least 90 percent of eighteen prompted infinitives, identify subject and relative time in ten unseen constructions with no more than one error, and convert three differently timed direct statements into accurate indirect statement.

Complete the assessment before opening the answer part. Record evidence, not confidence or elapsed time.

Evidence	First attempt	Delayed check
Date and conditions		
Worksheet ID and score		
Mastery task and result		
One recurring error family		
Correction stated as a rule		
Unseen or remediation item used		

If the criterion is met: continue to EL-II.4, Participles and the Ablative Absolute.

If it is not met: Worksheets II.10 and II.11 remain optional remediation or delayed-recall variants.

Advance / remediate decision: _____ **Next review date:** _____

Reason in one complete sentence: _____

Part V

Answer Key

Open this part only after completing the assessment record. Use the comparison and alternative-answer protocol in EL-GUIDE.

CHAPTER 1

Practice models and rubrics

The infinitive system — model and rubric

Model / acceptable evidence. Present infinitives are ordinarily simultaneous with the governing verb, perfect infinitives prior, and future infinitives subsequent; the active/passive axis separately identifies voice. Every cell must use the formation printed in the lesson.

Reading the forms in context — model and rubric

Model / acceptable evidence. A complementary infinitive completes the governing verb and ordinarily shares its subject; indirect statement has an accusative subject belonging to the reported proposition. The presence and role of that accusative, not an English “to” or “that”, decides the analysis.

Writing laboratory — model and rubric

Model / acceptable evidence. Each conversion must preserve simultaneous, prior, or subsequent relation to its governing report. A perfect infinitive marks priority relative to that report; absolute remoteness is not encoded by the infinitive label alone.

CHAPTER 2

Infinitives and indirect statement: parallel forms

Solution II.9 — Infinitives A

Worksheet ID: II.9

Focus: six infinitives, accusative subject, relative time**Use:** Draw a time arrow from each infinitive to its governing verb.

1. Give all six infinitives of *amo*.

Answer / model: *amare, amari; amavisse, amatum esse; amaturum esse, amatum iri*. Participial forms change to agree with an expressed subject.

2. Change direct *Christus venit* (he has come) after *Sacerdos dicit*.

Answer / model: *Sacerdos dicit Christum venisse*. Accusative *Christum* is subject; perfect *venisse* is prior to present *dicit*.

3. Translate the time contrast: *dixit eum orare / oravisse / oraturum esse*.

Answer / model: “He said that he was praying / had prayed / would pray.” The times are simultaneous, prior, and subsequent to *dixit*.

4. Explain agreement in *dicit hostias oblatas esse*.

Answer / model: *Hostias* is accusative plural subject; perfect passive participle *oblatas* agrees feminine accusative plural; action is prior and passive.

5. **Text:** *Existimantes autem illum esse in comitatu, venerunt iter diei*.

Passage ID: II.9.1; exact source and collation state are recorded in the passage inventory.

Mark the reported thought and translate.

Answer / notes: *Illum* is accusative subject of present infinitive *esse*; the thought is simultaneous with *existimantes*. “Thinking that he was in the company, they traveled a day’s journey.”

6. Write in Latin: “We know that Christ is Lord and that he will come.”

Answer / model: *Scimus Christum Dominum esse et venturum esse*. *Venturum* agrees with *Christum*; repeated *Christum* is unnecessary.

Solution II.12 — Infinitives D

Worksheet ID: II.12

Focus: six infinitives, accusative subject, relative time

Use: Draw a time arrow from each infinitive to its governing verb.

1. Give the infinitive system of deponent *sequor*.

Answer / model: Present *sequi*; perfect *secutum*, -am, -os, -as, -a *esse*; future *secuturum*, -am, -os, -as, -a *esse*. The participles agree with the accusative subject in every gender and number. All have active meaning; deponents have no separate passive infinitives here.

2. Report *Nos peccavimus* with a reflexive after *Confitentur*.

Answer / model: *Confitentur se peccavisse*. *Se* refers to the plural subject of *confitentur*; infinitive never changes for person.

3. Translate *putabant Christum venturum esse*.

Answer / model: “They thought that Christ would come.” *Christum* is accusative subject; *venturum* future active, subsequent to the thinking.

4. Explain why *dicit se Dominum esse* can be ambiguous outside context.

Answer / model: *Se* refers to the subject of *dicit*, but the identity of that subject must come from context; *Dominum* is predicate accusative.

5. **Text:** *Ita et vos existimate, vos mortuos quidem esse peccato, viventes autem Deo, in Christo Iesu Domino nostro.*

Passage ID: II.12.1; exact source and collation state are recorded in the passage inventory.

Supply the ellipsis and translate.

Answer / notes: The second *vos* is accusative subject of *esse*; *viventes* shares an omitted second *esse*. “So you too, consider yourselves indeed dead to sin but alive to God in Christ Jesus our Lord.”

6. Write in Latin: “He ordered the offering to be carried and said that it had been received.”

Answer / model: *Iussit oblationem perferri et dixit eam acceptam esse*. Both *oblationem* and *eam* are accusative subjects; *acceptam* agrees with *eam*.

Part VI

Scope and Sources

CHAPTER 1

Scope and Qualifications

1.1 Packet boundary

This is module EL-II.3, *Infinitives and Indirect Statement*, in Triptych's print-first Ecclesiastical Latin curriculum. It imports one authoritative lesson, transfer practice for its internal submodules, two selected worksheets, one local mastery assessment, and matching solutions. This packet covers the ordinary six-form system and indirect statement; exceptional infinitive constructions remain dictionary- and context-dependent.

The unprinted worksheet variants remain course-owned extension material; their omission is intentional and is not a claim that the module exhausts available practice. EL-GUIDE owns the course-wide study method, pacing, lookup discipline, answer protocol, source classes, and advancement rules; this packet assumes that orientation and terminology taught in prerequisite modules.

1.2 Controlling records and local state

Course-wide research records own the edition, passage, answer, curriculum, and source decisions; the leaf's module map records this packet's selection and transfer practice. EL-GUIDE owns the corpus, normalization, translation, non-authority, review, and answer conventions that apply here. Claim-local qualifications remain beside the affected material; check received wording against the course-wide passage inventory.

Any installed snapshot is a working study held from release until its exact bytes and outstanding distribution gates receive separate authorization.

CHAPTER 2

References

The following works are the course's controlling corpus and reference aids. Project-composed explanation, translation, analysis, exercises, and models are distinguished from received wording under the convention stated in the Scope and Qualifications appendix. Short source passages are identified so that the learner can verify their wider context. The adjacent edition manifest and passage inventory record exact source roles, checks, access states, and known rights limits.

2.1 Primary corpus

- Catholic Church, *Missale Romanum ex decreto SS. Concilii Tridentini restitutum, Summorum Pontificum cura recognitum*, editio typica (Rome, 1962). A searchable presentation of the edition is hosted by the Holy See's Biblia Clerus project: <https://www.clerus.org/bibliaclerusonline/EN/gmb.htm>.
- A page-image scan of the 1962 typical edition is available through the Church Music Association of America: <https://media.churchmusicassociation.org/pdf/missale62.pdf>. Page images, rather than unsourced transcriptions, should decide doubtful punctuation or spelling.

- The Clementine Vulgate is the principal biblical comparison corpus. The public-domain 1914 edition edited by Michael Hetzenauer and its provenance are described at <https://www.sacredbible.org/vulgate1914/>.

2.2 Grammar and lexicography

- J. H. Allen and J. B. Greenough, *New Latin Grammar for Schools and Colleges* (1903), a donor-declared public-domain reference whose digital locator was not independently consulted during integration: <https://archive.org/details/allengreenoughsn01alle>.
- Charles E. Bennett, *New Latin Grammar*, 1918 revision, Project Gutenberg eBook 15665; public-domain text in the United States: <https://www.gutenberg.org/ebooks/15665>.
- Charlton T. Lewis and Charles Short, *A Latin Dictionary* (1879), searchable transcription: <https://logeion.uchicago.edu/lexidium>.
- Charles du Fresne, sieur du Cange, *Glossarium mediae et infimae latinitatis*, a donor-declared later-vocabulary aid whose digital locator was not independently consulted during integration: <http://ducange.enc.sorbonne.fr/>.

The underlying 1903, 1918, 1879, and 1883–1887 printed works are public domain in the United States. Digital transcriptions and interfaces retain their own terms and are cited as access tools, not relicensed or reproduced wholesale. The 1962 Missal, Scripture, official text, and other received wording retain their own status; see the scope appendix, research records, and final-page rights notice.

Classical reference grammars describe the inherited system but do not by themselves explain every biblical or ecclesiastical development. The advanced volume therefore distinguishes classical baseline, Vulgate usage, later Christian usage, and stable liturgical formula instead of labeling every difference an “exception.”

2.3 Citation convention

Missal passages are cited by liturgical location and text genre rather than by a page number that varies among printings. Biblical texts are cited by book, chapter, and verse. Historical authors are cited by work and section wherever possible. A learner preparing a formal commentary should verify each passage against the edition actually being used and record any variant. These references are not a claim that every historical-linguistic question can be settled by the listed school grammars and dictionary interfaces.

CHAPTER 3

Generation Metadata

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Model: GPT-5-based Codex agent; unexposed: exact model identifier and model qualifiers

Agent/runtime: OpenAI Codex agents (curriculum architecture, module design, enrichment, source and answer audit, correction, production, and review); Codex CLI 0.144.6; API workspace; unexposed: server revision

Agent/runtime: OpenAI Codex agents (whole-curriculum structure audit, shared typesetting and selection correction, rendered-structure regression checks, production, and review); Codex CLI 0.144.6; API workspace; unexposed: server revision

Agent/runtime: OpenAI Codex agents (whole-curriculum Part-scoped numbering and rendered contents hierarchy correction, rendered contents-geometry regression checking, production, and review); Codex CLI 0.144.6; API workspace; unexposed: server revision

Agent/runtime: OpenAI Codex agents (starter-guide consolidation, module-flow and definition-retrieval revision, stage-boundary assessment correction, catalog and audit records, production, and review); Codex CLI 0.144.6; API workspace; unexposed: server revision

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